NOTING that, at several places, the entrances to the Baltic Sea are difficult to navigate, RESOLUTION MSC.138(76) (adopted on 5 December 2002) RECOMMENDATION ON NAVIGATION THROUGH THE ENTRANCES TO THE BALTIC SEAMSC 76/23/Add.1 ANNEX 12 Page 2 - RESOLUTION MSC.138(76) (adopted on 5 December 2002) RECOMMENDATION ON NAVIGATION THROUGH THE ENTRANCES TO THE BALTIC SEAMSC 76/23/Add.1 ANNEX 12 Page 2 I:\MSC\76\23-ADD.1.DOC NOTING ALSO that, owing to the risk of grounding or collision and the strong sea current, the navigation of large ships through the entrances to the Baltic Sea constitutes apotential danger of pollution of the entrances and of the entire Baltic Sea area, NOTING FURTHER that loaded oil and chemical tankers, gas carriers and ships carrying acargo of irradiated nuclear fuel, plutonium and high-level radioactive wastes (INF-cargoes) constitute apotential danger of pollution of the entrances to the Baltic Sea and apotential hazard to international shipping, HAVING CONSIDERED the recommendations of the Sub-Committee on Safety of Navigation at its forty-eighth session, 1. ADOPTS, in accordance with SOLAS regulation V/10, the Recommendation on navigation through the entrances to the Baltic Sea, as given in Annexes 1 and 2 to the present resolution; 2. DECIDES that the said Annexes will enter into force at 0000 hours UTC on 1 December 2003; - navigation through the entrances to the Baltic Sea, as given in Annexes 1 and 2 to the present resolution; 2. DECIDES that the said Annexes will enter into force at 0000 hours UTC on 1 December 2003; 3. REQUESTS the Secretary-General to bring this resolution and its Annexes to the attention of Member Governments and Contracting Governments to the 1974 SOLAS Convention. RESOLUTION MSC.138(76) (adopted on 5 December 2002) RECOMMENDATION ON NAVIGATION THROUGH THE ENTRANCES TO THE BALTIC SEAMSC 76/23/Add.1 ANNEX 12 Page 3 I:\MSC\76\23-ADD.1.DOC ANNEX 1 RECOMMENDATION ON NAVIGATION THROUGH THE ENTRANCES TO THE BALTIC SEA ROUTE - T 1 Ships over 40,000 tonnes deadweight, when pa ssing through the entrances to the Baltic Sea, in view of the fact that 17 mis the maximum obtainable depth without dredging in the area north-east of Gedser and that the charted depths, even under normal conditions, may be decreased